

SENATE RESOLUTION 289

By Akbari

A RESOLUTION to commend Delta Sigma Theta Sorority, Inc., on the occasion of its 2026 Tennessee Days at the Capitol and its Centennial celebration of social action in the Southern Region.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should honor and specially commend those distinguished organizations whose stated goals advance the most noble precepts of human endeavors and whose history of service in pursuit of those goals stands as a shining example to the citizens of this great State; and

WHEREAS, one such estimable organization that evinces the greatest integrity and probity is Delta Sigma Theta Sorority, Inc., an international organization composed of over 1,050 chartered chapters worldwide, representing more than 350,000 initiated members who remain committed to Sisterhood, Scholarship, Service, and Social Action; and

WHEREAS, Delta Sigma Theta Sorority, Inc., was founded on January 13, 1913, by twenty-two collegiate women at Howard University to promote academic excellence and provide assistance to those in need. The Founders' first act of public service was participating in the Women's Suffrage March of 1913; and

WHEREAS, a wide range of programs and service to the community have been implemented for over 113 years. The major programs of the Sorority are based upon the Five-Point Programmatic Thrust: economic development, educational development, international awareness and involvement, physical and mental health, and political awareness and involvement; and

WHEREAS, Cheryl W. Turner proudly serves as the International President and Chair of the Board of Directors; and

WHEREAS, the Southern Region was formed in 1926 and is the largest of the Sorority's seven regions, spanning Alabama, the Bahamas, Florida, Georgia, Mississippi, and the Great State of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, Amaris L. Johnson is the twenty-seventh Regional Director, and Noel Seymours is the Regional Representative; and

WHEREAS, on February 9-10, 2026, members from Tennessee's twenty-seven alumnae and collegiate chapters, along with Southern Regional Director Amaris L. Johnson and Southern Regional Social Action Coordinator Waikinya J.S. Clanton, will travel to the Tennessee State Capitol to attend work sessions focusing on the sorority's social action priorities, build relationships with legislators, and further engage in the legislative process; and

WHEREAS, Tennessee boasts impressive leadership with Keena Alexander as State Coordinator, Elise Russ as State Facilitator, Tamara Bates-Cast and Celia Q. Conley as State Social Action Coordinators and Delta Days at the Capitol Chairs, and Christiane Buggs-Frazier, Herbernita Jenkins, Kenya McGruder, Vivian Wilhoite, and Chandra Vasser as Nashville Chapter hostesses; and

WHEREAS, it is the policy of the Senate to celebrate exceptional organizations, especially those such as Delta Sigma Theta Sorority, Inc., whose extraordinary community service and advocacy bring honor to the State of Tennessee and improve the lives of future generations of Tennesseans; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that we commend the members of Delta Sigma Theta Sorority, Inc., for upon the occasion of their Tennessee Days at the Capitol, extending our gratitude for their exemplary service to their respective communities and applauding their efforts to improve the policies of the State and the well-being of its citizens.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy.